

Component 1: Non-fiction Texts and Transactional Writing (examined)

The focus of this component is:

Section A: Non-fiction texts – study and analyse selections from a range of non-fiction texts.

Section B: Transactional Writing – explore and develop transactional writing skills.

Content

Students should read a variety of high-quality, challenging non-fiction texts, in preparation to respond to one unseen non-fiction text in the examination. They should be able to read substantial pieces of writing, including whole and extended texts that make significant demands in terms of content, structure and the quality of the language. Throughout the qualification, students should develop the skills of interpretation and analysis.

Text types studied should include a range of non-fiction forms, such as journalism (for example articles and reviews), speeches, journals and reference book extracts.

Text types should also include literary non-fiction texts, such as selections from autobiography, letters, obituaries and travel writing. These lists are not exhaustive.

Texts that are essentially transient, such as instant news feeds and advertisements, will not form part of the assessment.

The *Pearson Edexcel International GCSE English Anthology* is a resource that supports teachers by providing examples of different types of non-fiction text. Students should be encouraged to read beyond the anthology to support their learning.

Students should use what they have learned about different text types to develop their transactional writing. They should be introduced to, and be given the opportunity to practise, a range of non-fiction writing techniques, planning and proofreading skills.

The transactional text types that students will be asked to write are:

- article for a magazine or newspaper
- speech
- letter
- guide
- review
- text of a leaflet.

The questions set may refer to a digital location for the texts, such as a website.

Pearson Edexcel International GCSE English Anthology

Part 1: Non-fiction Texts

From *The Danger of a Single Story*

Chimamanda Ngozi Adichie

From *A Passage to Africa*

George Alagiah

From *The Explorer's Daughter*

Kari Herbert

Explorers, or boys messing about? Either way, taxpayer gets rescue bill

Steven Morris

From *127 Hours: Between a Rock and a Hard Place*

Aron Ralston

Young and Dyslexic? You've got it going on

Benjamin Zephaniah

From *A Game of Polo with a Headless Goat*

Emma Levine

From *Beyond the Sky and Earth: A Journey into Bhutan*

Jamie Zeppa

From *H is for Hawk*

Helen Macdonald

From *Chinese Cinderella*

Adeline Yen Mah

Assessment overview

Component 1 assesses 60% of the total English Language (Specification A) qualification and assesses Reading (30%) and Writing (30%).

There will be two sections in the paper.

Section A: Non-fiction

- Students are advised to allocate 1 hour and 30 minutes including reading time to Section A.
- There will be a mixture of short- and long-answer questions related to a non-fiction text from Part 1 of the *Pearson Edexcel International GCSE English Anthology* and one previously unseen extract.
- Students will answer all questions in this section.
- Total of 45 marks for this section.

Questions will test the following assessment objectives:

- A01** read and understand a variety of texts, selecting and interpreting information, ideas and perspectives
- A02** understand and analyse how writers use linguistic and structural devices to achieve their effects
- A03** explore links and connections between writers' ideas and perspectives, as well as how these are conveyed.